

GIRIDHARAN RAJENDRAN

Senior Engineering Leader | Engineering Manager | Director of Engineering | DevSecOps | Platform Engineering | AI Agentic Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Engineering Leader and Engineering Manager with 20 years building and scaling high-performing global engineering teams across cloud infrastructure, SRE, DevSecOps, Platform Engineering, and AI-powered agentic systems. Proven people manager: led 12-member SRE team and 14-person cross-functional team; drove hiring, performance management, career development, and succession planning. Pioneered T-Mobile's first AI-agentic developer continuous delivery platform on Anthropic's MCP. Impact: \$1.2M+ cost savings, 5x deployments, 25% team satisfaction improvement, 3,100+ compliance hours saved annually. Trusted C-suite partner for strategic planning, executive communication, and OKR-driven engineering roadmaps.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Engineering Leadership and Management | People Management and Talent Development | Headcount Planning | Performance Management | Career Development | Employee Engagement | Succession Planning | Executive Communication | Stakeholder Management | Strategic Planning | Technical Program Management | SRE | DevSecOps | Cloud Architecture (AWS, Azure, GCP) | AI Agentic Systems | MCP | GenAI | IaC | High Availability | Cloud-Native Architecture | DevEx | Zero Trust Security | Kubernetes | CI/CD | GitOps | Observability | FinOps | Disaster Recovery | Agile | SAFe | OKRs

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership: People management, headcount planning, hiring, performance management, career development, succession planning, employee engagement, vendor management, budget governance, architecture review boards

AI and GenAI: Anthropic Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude API, LLM, RAG, ChromaDB, AI agentic systems, MCP server development, Claude Code integration, prompt engineering

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, IAM, Lambda), Azure (AKS, ADO, Key Vault, Data Explorer), GCP; multi-cloud, high availability

DevSecOps and CI/CD: GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, ArgoCD, GitOps, SonarQube, SAST/DAST, policy-as-code, zero trust, SOX compliance

Containers and IaC: Kubernetes (EKS, AKS), Docker, Helm, Istio, Terraform, Ansible, Python, Golang, FastAPI, Next.js, Backstage.io

Observability and SRE: Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog, Splunk, SLI/SLO/SLA, chaos engineering, MTTR reduction, incident management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Leader -- SRE, DevSecOps and Platform Engineering | **T-Mobile USA** | Oct 2019 - Present

- Built and scaled 12-member SRE team — hiring, performance management, career development, succession planning; team satisfaction +25% YoY, engineers promoted into leadership roles.
- Architected 100+ workload migration to Azure/Kubernetes (Terraform, ArgoCD, GitOps) — 85% cost reduction, \$1.2M+ annual savings.
- **CDP Hub -- AI-Powered Platform (Flagship Innovation Project):** Pioneered T-Mobile's official Continuous Delivery Platform (CDP) developer portal -- unified interface consolidating GitLab CI/CD tooling, platform observability, self-service automation, and organizational intelligence. Core: AI assistant powered by Claude delivering instant answers from CDP documentation, runbooks, pipeline data, and organizational context; Jira integration for ticket creation and tracking; real-time platform monitoring. Reduced Support tickets 70%; accelerated software delivery across T-Mobile engineering teams.
- Built CDP-MCP Server on Anthropic's Model Context Protocol (MCP) -- enabling developers to connect via Claude Code, VSCode, or Cursor to invoke 22+ CDP tools autonomously through natural language, transforming how engineering teams interact with the platform.
- Built GitLab CI/CD with SAST/DAST, SonarQube, policy-as-code — deployment frequency 5x, build reliability +60%.
- SOX CM.02/CM.03 Compliance Automation: Automated Change and Configuration Management controls across 22 SOX applications — 264+ hrs/month saved (3,100+ annually), 100% audit readiness, zero findings.
- Architected observability platform (Grafana, Prometheus, Datadog) — MTTR -45%, outages -30% YoY, 99.9% high availability; delivered executive KPI dashboards cutting reporting time 75%.
- Drove C-suite stakeholder management, strategic planning, and OKR-driven engineering roadmap aligned with T-Mobile's digital transformation; led architecture review boards and vendor management.

Associate Manager, Software Engineering | **Accenture** | Sep 2010 - Oct 2019

- People management lead, 14-person cross-functional DevOps team — hiring, performance reviews, career development; delivery velocity +65% through Agile/CI/CD adoption.
- Directed T-Mobile Rebellion modernization — automation frameworks cutting release cycles 70%; technical standards adopted org-wide through automation-first SRE architecture.
- Automated 90% of manual ops; 99.9% SLA across 52+ apps with 24x7 on-call support; monitoring systems boosted incident response 60%; OKR roadmaps with executive leadership.

Senior Software Engineer | **Alcatel-Lucent** | Oct 2009 - Sep 2010

- Designed Unix/Python automation tooling and REST API integrations; independently architected deployment pipelines — manual overhead -30%.

System Engineer | **Wipro Technologies** (Jan 2008 - Sep 2009) **Junior Engineer** | **LASON India Pvt Ltd** (May 2006 - Sep 2007) |

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

- **T-Mobile MVP Award, Q2 2026** -- Outstanding overall platform impact and customer experience improvement.
- **University of Phoenix President's List, Jan-Jun 2026** -- Highest academic standing in MBA program while working full-time at T-Mobile.
- **University of Phoenix Dean's List** -- Exceptional academic achievement in the MBA program.

SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- **Speaker, GitLab Commit (Global DevOps Conference):** Represented T-Mobile presenting "Build Together, Grow Together -- Inner Source Templates"; featured by GitLab (1.1M+ followers); 73 engagements, 18 comments from global DevOps community.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), In Progress -- **President's List, Jan-Jun 2026** -- University of Phoenix (Expected 2026)

Post Graduate Program in Cloud Computing -- University of Texas at Austin (2021)

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) in Electronics and Communication Engineering -- Anna University, India (2005)

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

AI and ML

- Generative AI and ML Fundamentals (2025) | Agentic AI (2026) | AI Risk Management (2026) | Databricks Generative AI Fundamentals (2024)
- ML and Supervised Learning -- Skillsoft (2025) | AI Ethical Challenges and Risks -- Skillsoft (2025)

DevOps, Architecture and Leadership

- GitLab Certified Git Associate (2024) | Red Hat Certified Engineer RHCE | SRE Management (2025) | Certified Technology Architect (2012)
- SAFe 5 Product Owner and Product Manager (2022) | Leadership Development Program (2025)

MBA Badges (University of Phoenix)

- Strategic Leadership | Financial Management | Operational Efficiency